



To Professors

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Organising Committee

Adam Smith at 250 Conference

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Dear colleagues

06 April 2026

Recommendation for Aris Grivokostopoulos, LSE

Rapporteur expression of interest

I am writing in enthusiastic support of the application of my student Aristeidis Grivokostopoulos for the rapporteur position at the Wealth of Nations at 250 conference at Glasgow in October.

Aris joined the LSE Economic History PhD programme in September 2024, funded by an ESRC DTP studentship. He is a second-year PhD student with four working papers in circulation, conference presentations at WEHC (Lund, 2025) and the WEAI Annual Conference (San Francisco, 2025), and affiliations with the LSE Data Science Institute and the Hellenic Observatory. His research is directly relevant to all three of his preferred assignments.

Aris' paper "Between Civilisation and Constitution: Greek Parliamentary Debates on Gold Standard Adoption, 1875-1885", prepared for the Mary Morgan Retirement Workshop (June 2026), applies Morgan's models-as-mediators framework to show how economic ideas fail when applied without their institutional preconditions. This research connects directly to the questions Besley and Ghatak raise about values and institutions and to Rodrik's argument about contextual versus universal economic policy. A companion paper uses 755 roll call votes to test whether fiscal shocks shift legislators from clientelist to programmatic behaviour, extending the same institutional analysis to the legislative level.

Aris' work on sovereign debt restructuring in the Ottoman Empire, Egypt, and Greece uses bond-level London Stock Exchange data to estimate the credit market effects of war-driven

fiscal supervision. This connects directly to the fiscal infrastructure questions at the heart of Voth's chapter on the infrastructure-building properties of war finance.

Aris is a good writer producing texts for audiences across economic history and the history of economic thought, and also teaches for EC311 (History of Economic Thought) at LSE.

I support his application most strongly and without reservations. Please do not hesitate to get back to me with any queries.

Yours faithfully,

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading 'Albrecht Ritschl'. The signature is written in a cursive style with a large, stylized 'A' and a long, sweeping underline.

Albrecht Ritschl
Professor